ACME ROBOTICS

Employee Handbook 2026

How we work, how we take time off, and how we grow together. Applies to all employees based in Portugal and Spain.

Version 3.2 · Effective 1 January 2026 · Owner: People & Culture team
Fictional company. Sample document created to demonstrate a document Q&A assistant.

1. Welcome to Acme Robotics

Acme Robotics designs autonomous warehouse robots and the software that coordinates them. We are a team of 240 people across offices in Lisbon, Porto and Madrid. This handbook explains the policies that shape everyday work at Acme. When a policy here conflicts with your employment contract, the contract prevails.

If something is unclear, ask your manager or write to the People & Culture team at people@acme-robotics.example. We review this handbook every January and announce changes in the company all-hands meeting.

2. Working Hours and Hybrid Work

2.1 Working week

The standard working week is 40 hours, Monday to Friday. Core collaboration hours are **10:00 to 16:00 (Lisbon time)**. Outside core hours you may organise your schedule freely, as long as your team agrees and customer commitments are met.

2.2 Hybrid work policy

Acme follows a hybrid model. Employees may work remotely **up to 3 days per week**. Each team chooses at least one shared "anchor day" per week when everyone is in the office for planning, reviews and social time.

- Remote days must be registered in the HR portal by Friday of the previous week.
- Working from another country is allowed for up to **20 working days per calendar year**, with prior approval from your manager and the People & Culture team.
- Robotics lab and hardware testing roles may have specific on-site requirements defined by their department.

> Home office support: every new employee receives a one-off home office allowance of **EUR 300** for a chair, monitor or other ergonomic equipment. Receipts must be submitted within 60 days of your start date.

3. Time Off

3.1 Annual leave

Full-time employees are entitled to **25 working days** of paid annual leave per calendar year, plus your birthday off. Part-time employees receive a pro-rated amount. Leave requests should be submitted in the HR portal at least two weeks in advance for absences longer than three days.

Unused leave may be carried over to the following year up to a maximum of **5 days**, and those days must be used by **31 March**. Any carried-over days not used by that date are lost.

3.2 Other types of leave

Type of leave	Entitlement	How to request
Sick leave	Paid from day one; medical certificate after 3 consecutive days	Notify your manager before 10:00 on the first day
Parental leave	Statutory leave plus 2 extra paid weeks from Acme	HR portal, at least 30 days before the expected date
Bereavement	Up to 5 paid days	Inform your manager; no advance notice needed
Volunteering	2 paid days per year	HR portal, with the organisation's name
Moving house	1 paid day per year	HR portal

Table 1. Leave types and entitlements for employees in Portugal and Spain.

4. Learning and Development

We believe that engineers, operators and support staff all grow faster when they keep learning. Every employee has an individual **learning budget of EUR 1,500 per year** and **3 paid learning days** per year.

4.1 What the learning budget covers

- Courses, certifications and exam fees related to your current or future role.
- Books and online learning subscriptions.
- Conference registration fees, including workshops attached to the conference.

Travel and accommodation for conferences are **not** paid from the learning budget. They are charged to your department's travel budget and must follow the Travel and Expense Policy.

4.2 Attending conferences

To attend a conference you need your manager's approval at least **4 weeks before the event**. After the conference, we ask you to share three key takeaways with your team, either in a short write-up or in a 15-minute talk at the team meeting.

> Unused learning budget does not carry over to the next year. Plan your learning goals with your manager during the September performance review.

5. Equipment and Tools

Every employee receives a laptop, a headset and access to the tools needed for their role. Laptops are refreshed every **3 years**, or earlier if a device no longer meets performance requirements for your work.

- Company equipment remains Acme property and must be returned when you leave the company.
- Software must be installed through the Self Service portal. Requests for new tools are reviewed by IT within 2 working days.
- All devices must follow the IT Security Guidelines, including encryption, multi-factor authentication and screen locking.

6. Performance and Feedback

Performance reviews take place twice a year, in **March** and **September**. Each review combines a self-assessment, feedback from two peers chosen together with your manager, and a conversation about goals for the next six months.

Salary reviews happen once a year, in March, and take into account performance, market data and the scope of your role. Promotions can be proposed at either review cycle.

7. Wellbeing

All employees have access to private health insurance from the first day of employment, a confidential counselling service with up to 6 free sessions per year, and a monthly wellbeing allowance of EUR 30 that can be used for gym memberships or sports activities.

8. Code of Conduct

We expect everyone at Acme to act with integrity, respect and care for safety. Harassment and discrimination of any kind are not tolerated. Concerns can be raised with your manager, the People & Culture team, or anonymously through the Ethics Line. Retaliation against anyone who raises a concern in good faith is a serious disciplinary offence.

Safety comes first in our robotics labs and customer warehouses: always follow the lab safety briefing, wear the required protective equipment, and stop any test immediately if you see a risk to people or property.

Acme Robotics is a fictional company. This handbook is sample content created to demonstrate the Lumen document Q&A assistant.